

Pactpage

Proposal. Sign. Get paid. — the HoneyBook slice, not a HoneyBook clone.

End-to-end plan for a solo builder: what the product is, what it is not, name and legal checks, stack, 4-week MVP, e-sign and payments rules, pricing, launch, and kill criteria.

This is a product brief. It is not legal, tax, or e-sign compliance advice. Confirm the name and domain yourself before you print cards.

1. What this actually is

HoneyBook is an all-in-one operating system for service businesses: CRM, scheduling, proposals, contracts, invoices, projects, automations, a client portal. After the 2025 price hike, Starter sits around \$36/mo and Premium around \$129/mo. Freelancers who only needed three documents now pay for a suite.

Pactpage is not that suite. It is one link that does three jobs in order:

- You write a short proposal (scope, price, timeline).
- The client signs on the same page.
- Stripe collects the deposit or full amount. You get email: Paid.

One sentence: Give a freelancer a paid, signed job without opening HoneyBook, DocuSign, and Stripe separately.

The aha screen

Client opens pactpage.com/s/acme-site. They see your name, a one-page scope, a \$1,200 line, a sign box, and Pay deposit \$600. After pay: you see “Acme — signed + \$600 received.” That is the NotchBuddy moment. One glance. Done.

Who pays

Solo designers, photographers, coaches, web freelancers, wedding vendors who left HoneyBook or never started it. They already send a Google Doc + a PayPal link. They want it to look paid, not “together.” They will not migrate a CRM.

2. What you must not build

- Pipeline / CRM / leads inbox.
- Calendar booking or Zoom.
- Project tasks, time tracking, client portal v1.
- AI that writes the whole proposal (optional later; not the product).
- QuickBooks write-back, team seats, white-label agencies.
- Holding client money yourself. Stripe Checkout or Payment Links only.

The second you add scheduling you are competing with Calendly plus HoneyBook. Stay three steps.

3. Name

Working name for this plan: **Pactpage**. Tagline: Proposal. Sign. Get paid.

I cannot certify a name is globally free. Before you buy ads, run all of these yourself: Google exact match, USPTO TESS, India IP India public search, UK IPO, Namecheap/Porkbun whois, app stores, GitHub, X handle, Stripe descriptor.

Name	Why	Watch-outs	Use?
Pactpage	Pact + page. Says contract and a single URL. Easy to say.	Check pactpage.com / .co. No famous collision found in a quick web pass. Still verify trademarks.	Primary
Aftersign	Describes the moment after they sign (pay).	Generic-ish. Check aftersign.com. Weaker brand.	Backup
Dealplain	Plain deal. Matches the anti-bloat story.	Sounds like a newsletter. Check spelling confusion.	Backup
Paidbrief	Paid + brief. Clear for designers.	Two words mashed. Check paidbrief.com.	Backup
Honey-anything / Book-anything / PactPay / Paperclip / Inkpact / SealSend	Do not.	HoneyBook, Paperclip (agent OS), Inkpact (print/handwritten mail), PactPay and SealSend already exist.	Never

Company legal name can be different from the product name (e.g. your Pvt Ltd or LLC). Product name is a trademark you apply for after you have first revenue, not before the landing page. Do not print merch until the domain is in your account.

Legal hygiene on the name

- Do not use HoneyBook’s logo, purple, bee, or the word HoneyBook in your logo.
- “HoneyBook alternative” is fine as comparison copy on a blog. It is not a brand.
- Register the .com if under \$20. If taken, .co is acceptable for v1. Avoid lookalike typos of HoneyBook.
- Grab @pactpage on X if free. If not, @getpactpage.

4. How you are cheaper, on purpose

	HoneyBook	Pactpage
Job	Run the whole client company	Get one job signed and paid
Price	\$36–\$129/mo typical	\$12/mo or \$79 lifetime for first 50
Setup	Onboarding wizard, templates, pipeline	One template, send link
Integrations v1	Dozens	Stripe + email only
Who it hurts	Solos who wanted three buttons	Agencies who need a CRM

If a prospect asks for a scheduler, say no and keep the price. That is the product.

5. MVP screens (only these)

- Signup: email + password or Google. Create workspace with display name, logo, currency.
- New job: client name, email, title, scope (rich text), line items, deposit %, due date.
- Share: unique URL. Optional password. Status: draft / sent / viewed / signed / paid / expired.
- Client page: your branding, scope, totals, sign (name + click + timestamp + IP), then Stripe Checkout for deposit or full.
- You: list of jobs. Filter unpaid. Download signed PDF. Resend link.
- Settings: Stripe connect (or your Stripe + payout to you if you only invoice your own clients — see payments).
- Billing for Pactpage itself: Stripe Checkout \$12/mo.

Data model (keep tiny)

users, workspaces, clients, documents (proposal+contract as one record), line_items, events (viewed, signed, paid), payments (stripe ids). That is enough.

6. Stack (solo, 2026)

Layer	Pick	Why
App	Next.js on Vercel	Fast ship. One repo.
DB + auth	Supabase (Postgres + Auth + storage for PDFs)	Boring. Enough.
Payments in	Stripe Checkout + webhooks	Do not store cards.
Your SaaS billing	Stripe Billing \$12/mo	Same account, different product.
E-sign	Do not invent crypto signatures. Use DocuSign self-host or BoldSign API. Or a recorded clickwrap plus hashed PDF if you stay US-only and disclose it is simple e-sign, not Qualified eIDAS.	Liability lives here.
Email	Resend	Transactional only.
PDF	react-pdf or Puppeteer snapshot of the signed page	Store in Supabase storage.
Payments from India	Stripe if you can get it, else Dodo / Lemon Squeezy / Paddle as merchant of record	MoR handles VAT/GST on your \$12 plan. Client job payments still go to the freelancer's Stripe.

Critical: the freelancer's client pays the freelancer, not you. You only charge the freelancer \$12. If you route client money through your account you become a payments business. Do not.

7. E-sign and money (read this)

In the US, the E-SIGN Act and UETA generally allow electronic signatures if the person intended to sign and you keep a record (name, time, IP, document hash). That is how most startup “sign here” tools start. It is not a Qualified Electronic Signature under eIDAS. Do not sell to EU notaries or government tenders.

In India, the IT Act recognizes electronic signatures; Aadhaar eSign is a different, regulated path. For v1, target US/UK/AU freelancers paying in USD via Stripe. Put in the footer: “Simple electronic signature. Not a digital signature certificate.”

- Keep an audit log: document version hash, signer name, email, IP, user agent, timestamp.
- Lock the PDF after sign. Do not let either side edit quietly.
- Terms + privacy + cookie banner. DPA later when you have EU users.
- You are not a law firm. No “this contract is legally reviewed.”

8. Four-week build

Week 0 — before code

Message 15 people who posted about leaving HoneyBook. Offer to send their next client a manual version: you make a Notion page + Stripe payment link this week for free. If fewer than 3 say yes, stop. The clone only works if they still want a smaller bill.

Week 1

- Auth, workspace, one document editor (title, scope, one price).
- Public share URL. View tracking.
- Ugly but live on a custom domain.

Week 2

- Sign step + audit log + frozen PDF.
- Stripe Checkout for amount on the doc. Webhook marks paid.
- Email: sent / signed / paid.

Week 3

- Line items, deposit %, expiry date, your logo.
- Your own \$12 billing.
- 5 templates: web project, photoshoot, coaching month, brand kit, retainers.

Week 4

- Polish client page. Mobile sign.
- One-page marketing site. Demo video 40 seconds.
- Launch list: 10 warm users on the \$9 founder price.

9. Pricing

Plan	Price	Limit	Purpose
Founder (first 50)	\$9/mo or \$79 lifetime	20 sent docs / mo	X launch, same trick as NotchBuddy
Solo	\$12/mo	40 sent docs / mo	Default

Plan	Price	Limit	Purpose
Busy	\$29/mo	Unlimited docs, custom domain	Photographers in season

Math: 170 people on \$12 = \$2,040 MRR. 100 on \$29 = \$2,900. Lifetime deals help cash, hurt the sale of the company. Cap lifetime at 50, then kill it.

Do not take a cut of client payments. That feels cheap and makes you a payments firm. Charge the freelancer. They already understand software rent.

10. Launch (no big website first)

Site copy, one screen:

HoneyBook got expensive. You still just need a proposal, a signature, and a payment. Pactpage is that link. \$12/mo.

- Record you sending a fake \$50 job to yourself and paying it. 40 seconds. That is the demo.
- Post in r/freelance, r/graphic_design, r/weddingphotography, r/webdev, Indie Hackers. Pain first, link second.
- X: same demo. Do not buy ads until 20 paid.
- Reply in HoneyBook alternative threads with the three-step story, not “we are cheaper.”
- Onboard by doing their first document with them on a 15 min call. That is distribution.

Do not post this in r/Bookkeeping. Wrong buyer, and that sub blocks product research.

11. Support load you should expect

Failed Stripe, client says they signed but you did not get paid, “can you add packages,” PDF looks wrong on iPhone, “can it sync to HoneyBook.” Answer the first two. For the last two, no.

Write a one-page FAQ before launch. Every extra feature request is how this becomes HoneyBook.

12. Kill / continue rules

After 21 days	Do
0 warm users will send a real client through a manual version	Stop. Category is habit, not price.
People want a scheduler before they will pay \$12	You picked the wrong slice. Do not add calendar.
3 paid \$12 and they send a second job the same month	Keep building. That is the loop.
You are writing CRM boards	You already lost. Reset the repo.

13. 90-day picture if it works

- Month 1: 10 paying. You still hop on calls.
- Month 2: templates + custom domain. 40 paying.

- Month 3: 80–120 paying or you do not have a company. Sell only after 3 months of stable MRR, not after a launch spike.

Exit later is a small freelance-tool rollup (Empire Flippers / Acquire). Multiples are higher on subscription than on lifetime Mac apps. That is why this is \$12/mo, not \$29 once.

Start Monday with Week 0, not with Figma. The name Pactpage is a placeholder until the domain and trademark search are done in your name. Then ship the link.

One line to tape above the monitor: three steps, twelve dollars, no CRM.